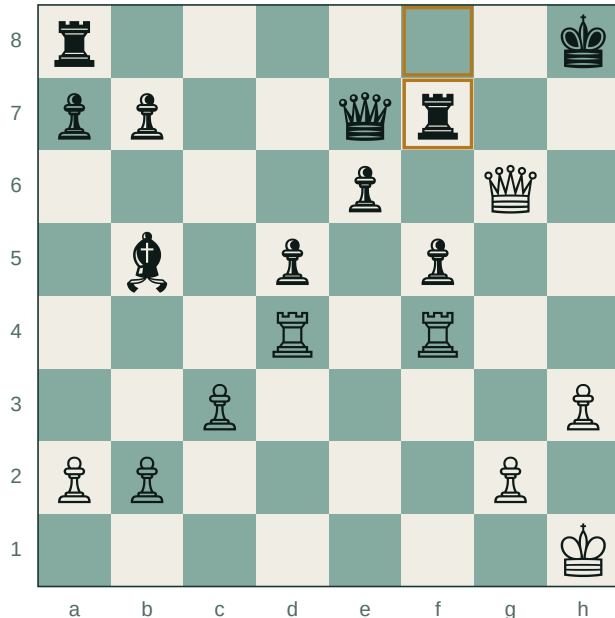


# Exposed-king tactics: White, move 28

Exposed-king tactics

White to move



Previous move: 27...Rf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**28. Rh4+ Rh7 29. Rxh7+ Qxh7 30. Qf6+ Kg8 31. Rh4 Qxh4 32. Qxh4**

**28.Rh4+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **28...Rh7**.

**29.Rxh7+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From h7 it attacks king on h8 and queen on e7. Recorded reply: **29...Qxh7**.

**30.Qf6+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **30...Kg8**.

**31.Rh4** The rook moves from d4 to h4. Recorded reply: **31...Qxh4**.

**32.Qxh4** The queen captures the queen on h4.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -3 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and bishop on b5. Check for tactical protection.